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"All the News That's Fit to Print"

# The New York Times

THE WEATHER
**Today,** sunny, cooler, a light breeze, high 59. **Tonight,** clear, calm wind, low 45. **Tomorrow,** sunny morning, partly cloudy, light north winds, high 59. Weather map, Page B12.

VOL. CLXXVI .... No. 61,050 © 2026 The New York Times Company TUESDAY, OCTOBER 27, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00



MIGUEL SCHINCARIOL/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

Supporters of President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva of Brazil gathered in São Paulo after voters returned him to office for a fourth term.

## *Israel Heads to the Polls, Its Identity in the Balance*

### *Hard-Right Nationalism Vies With Centrist Ideals in Clash Over Nation's Future*

By ROGER COHEN

Simcha Rothman, a pillar of Israel's hard right, gazes from his hilltop settlement in the West Bank at pomegranate trees, vineyards and, in the distance, the Judean Desert's barren hills falling away in a haze toward the Dead Sea.

"This is our land," he says, "historically, biblically, religiously and lawfully."

Most of the world, and the three million Palestinians who live there, side with international law against that view. They call Israel's 59-year occupation of the West Bank illegal, along with the settlements that now blanket the land known to most Israelis as Judea and Samaria, the birthplace of the Jewish people.

This settlement, called Pnei Kedem, a cluster of houses that has grown to 90 families from 16 since Mr. Rothman moved here 18 years ago, is reached along roads from Jerusalem now lined with bedraggled Israeli flags — and dotted with the election billboards of Bezalel Smotrich, Israel's firebrand finance minister, who leads Mr. Rothman's Religious Zionist party.

"Smotrich: Deeds not words!" the posters say.

Those deeds include soaring settler violence against Palestinians and the rapid spread of wildcat outposts, the clusters of caravans through which the Israel of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu stamps on the land its clear intent: permanent control of the West Bank.

A big man with a wide-eyed gaze and a relentless conviction, Mr. Rothman, 46, waves away the violence. "If Judea and Samaria were a city in the United States," he tells me, "it would be considered one of the safest cities."

As for the land he sees as deeded by God to the Jewish people, it is nonnegotiable. "No to a Palestinian state, ever," he says. "Any sovereign nation between the river and the sea that is not the state of Israel means our destruction."

In Israel's watershed election on Tuesday, the country's very identity appears at stake. On one side, an ever more strident and violent nationalism, often messianic in tone, has seeped into Israel's fabric. Mr. Rothman's position on Palestinian statehood places him in the mainstream.

On the other, opponents appalled by this lurch to the right still cling to a diverse nation and some trace of the charter of Israel's foundation in 1948, which calls for "complete equality of social and political rights to all its inhabitants, irrespective of religion, race or sex."

Prominent among them is Yoav Segalovitz, 67, a soft-spoken former Israeli police officer who has crossed entrenched barriers to become a candidate for an Arab party, Raam, in the hope of preserving those founding ideals.

It is something no other centrist

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### Pushing to Attack Iran

Israel's Benjamin Netanyahu sought a new airstrike before Tuesday's elections but ran into military resistance. Page A7.

## *Lula's Victory Curtails Right In the Region*

By ANA IONOVA and ADAM B. ELLICK

BRASÍLIA — Brazilian voters have handed the leftist president, Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, a fourth term in office and a surprise victory over Flávio Bolsonaro, his right-wing challenger, in a striking rebuke to a conservative surge sweeping Latin America.

Mr. Bolsonaro refused to accept Sunday's outcome and said it was the result of foul play, seizing on a narrative that his father also employed after his own electoral loss four years ago.

President Trump on Monday also criticized the results of the vote, telling reporters at Joint Base Andrews in Maryland that "it looked like another rigged election."

The rejection by voters of Mr. Bolsonaro, the son of a former president jailed for attempting a coup four years ago, is also a loss for President Trump, who had embraced the Bolsonaro family and the region's rising right.



In contrast to many world leaders, Mr. Lula has often clashed with President Trump.

Mr. Lula, in contrast to many world leaders, has often and defiantly clashed with Mr. Trump, and his victory highlights that Latin America's left-wing forces still wield influence despite a string of losses across the hemisphere. This is the first leftist victory following seven straight wins by right-wing leaders in the region over the last 18 months.

"I would like to thank the Brazilian people for the generosity they have shown me for a long time," Mr. Lula said, during a victory speech in São Paulo, flanked by his wife, running mate and allies.

The result capped a chaotic final stretch of the race, as polling places were ordered to remain open after public transportation

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## Edgy Markets See Bellwether in Anthropic I.P.O.

### A Disappointing Debut Could Shake A.I.

By ERIN GRIFFITH and LAUREN HIRSCH

SAN FRANCISCO — When Anthropic goes public as soon as next month, its initial offering will be more than just a coming-out party for the artificial intelligence company. It will also be a litmus test for the economy, with trillions of dollars at stake.

Anthropic, which makes the Claude chatbot, is a tent pole of the A.I. industry. Valued in the private markets at nearly $1 trillion and backed by more than $130 billion in funding, it could raise $100 billion in its offering and promptly become one of the world's biggest public companies. But the stakes are even higher than that.

Anthropic and OpenAI, its chief rival, sit atop a pyramid of business partners and suppliers — infrastructure providers, chipmakers, energy companies and A.I. start-ups — that have all spent heavily over the past four years because they believe demand for A.I. products will keep growing.

Anthropic's listing will provide the first in-depth look at the health of a key business underlying the

*Continued on Page A19*

**MISSION STATEMENT** Anthropic outlines a future of promise with A.I., but also of peril. PAGE B1

## *Review Boards Defy Pentagon On Trans Ban*

By DAVE PHILIPPS

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth used a slur to proudly announce to an auditorium of Marines in September that he was ridding the military of all transgender troops.

The Pentagon had set up review boards at bases around the globe, manned by everyday uniformed service members with narrow orders that all but ensured that the trans troops appearing before them would be voted out.

But just steps from the auditorium where Mr. Hegseth spoke, at Marine Corps Base Quantico, boards assigned to carry out those orders were doing the opposite. Instead of firing trans Marines, the boards were voting to keep them.

The same was happening in the Navy: Boards given strict rules instructing them to force out sailors were rebelling and voting to let them stay.

It is not just a few outlying individuals. Navy and Marine Corps boards have voted to retain trans members in nine of 12 cases.

The Pentagon keeps the proceedings secret. Outsiders — even spouses — are not allowed to attend. Officials won't release numbers. Leaders won't discuss the outcomes. The New York Times compiled the figures through interviews with service members and lawyers involved in the hearings.

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PHOTOGRAPHS BY CHIARA NEGRELLO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

**They Look, if Not Play, Marvelous**

Venezia F.C. has long struggled to make its way in Italian soccer. But it designed uniforms that have become a cult style hit and part of a brand that plays on the character of Venice. Page B6.

## A License? Teens Can Contain Their Excitement.

### Many Delay Milestones Like Driving Now

By CALLIE HOLTERMANN

DETROIT — The video game Grand Theft Auto allows players to steal vehicles, blow up factories and race monster trucks. That all sounds exciting, but Korey Batey, a driving instructor in Detroit, has been using the game to show teenagers how to parallel park.

"Now we turn that wheel to the left, just like that, and back it up, nice and easy," Batey, 37, says in a TikTok video of himself guiding a black sedan into a tight spot. In another, he traverses the game's roadways to point out the difference between stop and yield signs.

A few decades ago, a driver's license was just about the most exciting thing you could offer a teenager. That little card offered a tantalizing taste of freedom. Passing the road test was a rite of passage for young adults eager to live life on their own terms; failing was a plot point in coming-of-age movies like "License to Drive" (1988, starring Coreys Haim and Feld-

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NEWS ANALYSIS

## *Before Election, President Tries Undermining It*

By ZOLAN KANNO-YOUNGS

WASHINGTON — For months, President Trump has mounted a sustained effort to attack the integrity of U.S. elections while using the federal government to try to assert more control over the voting process overseen by states.

Last week, Mr. Trump opened a new front.

Rather than simply push false claims at his rallies or target voters his administration claims should not be on the rolls, Mr. Trump moved to pre-emptively challenge the certification of Alaska's Senate election if the Republican candidate narrowly loses.

In doing so, Mr. Trump harnessed the power of the federal government to try to interfere in the voting process before Election Day — essentially trying to nullify an opponent's potential win before the game has been called.

Even for a president who worked to undermine and overturn the 2020 presidential election, the anticipatory strike reflects a new intensification of Mr. Trump's attempts to use his official powers to achieve the election results he wants — one that undermines the democratic process, according to election and legal experts. While they say

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

**Lessons From Serbia's Election**
In much of Europe, the advance of the right has been seen as unstoppable. But in the east, some nationalists are being cast aside. News Analysis. PAGE A8

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**Chance to Alter Senate Map**
Democrats are targeting Republican strongholds but if they don't win, it could be a long time before they have another chance. PAGE A16

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**The Joy of a 'Wicker' Husband**
Alexander Skarsgard and Olivia Colman discuss nontoxic masculinity, unusual love interests and the process of bringing an adult fable to life. PAGE C1

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**Is Rabies Making a Comeback?**
As several states report a surge of cases in animals, federal officials have been warning about an apparent increase in human exposures. PAGE D1

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**The Editorial Board** PAGE A20

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